

other components of information technology.

This chain reaction has caused an explosion in the Internet and because of this explosion and congregation of technologies and ideas; the Web has now become notorious for services which were once the domain of software which ran on PCs under the heading of packages and utilities. We thought of trying our hand at some of these services and were amazed. Three of these services are explored in this chapter.

9.1 Online File Storage

If you are the person who has a business operation spanning countries or even cities, or if you're someone who the traveling bug has bitten badly, and needs to access large amounts of data wherever you go, You're going to need online file storage services. Besides this, if you find that your e-mail service has an attachment limit that's just too small for your liking, again, online storage is for you.

Other advantages of these services include security against virus attacks and data corruption—even backing up to CDs fails every now and then. Some of the sites we will look at are free, while others offer both free and paid options.

If you do not want the hassles of upgrading to new hardware every time you run out of disk space, or when storage technology changes, you should consider online storage as an option for storing, accessing and sharing your data.

With all of these sites you get a few GB of storage, so you don't have to worry about the size of the data you are backing up or just sharing. In addition, some sites have rules against objectionable content, which are adhered to strictly.

On the more technical side, the memberships to some of these Web sites also offer more facilities in terms of downloads per hour, maximum storage allowed, support for download accelerators, password protection for each download, choice of HTTP or FTP download, and sending files to multiple recipients. Moreover, you can also choose to share your files with the